ALLY WEALTH • AUTHOR VISIBILITY CONSULTANT

Amazon Book Discoverability Guide

A reader-centred framework for improving the clarity and findability of a book detail page.

A practical workbook and reference guide

EDUCATIONAL RESOURCE • 2026 EDITION

How to use this guide

Store discoverability is a combination of relevance, presentation, reader confidence and the platform's own systems. No author can control search algorithms or guarantee placement. This guide explains a disciplined way to review the elements an author can influence, while reminding readers to verify current KDP and marketplace guidance before making changes.

Work through the pages in order. Use the prompts to make decisions, record assumptions and identify actions. You can revisit a page when your book, audience or publishing plan changes.

Keep the work evidence-aware. Platform interfaces, policies and marketplace features change. Verify current official guidance before acting on platform-specific instructions. Treat examples as planning aids, not guarantees.

Make it your own. Not every tactic belongs in every campaign. Choose the actions that fit your book, resources, readers and values.

Contents

01	Understand the discovery journey
02	Begin with accurate book data
03	Write for reader intent
04	Build a keyword research map
05	Use comparable titles responsibly
06	Understand category fit
07	Review the book description
08	Make the opening lines count
09	Check cover-to-listing consistency
10	Evaluate the sample experience
11	Understand format relationships
12	Review pricing context
13	Create an author-page pathway
14	Use series information strategically
15	Consider A+ content carefully
16	Design visual modules for scanning
17	Audit the listing as a whole
18	Understand also-bought and recommendations
19	Connect external traffic responsibly
20	Build a before-and-after record
21	Understand keyword field limits
22	Avoid prohibited or misleading terms
23	Plan controlled updates
24	Measure what is available

25	Interpret results cautiously
26	Troubleshoot weak conversion
27	Plan a listing refresh
28	Keep a platform change log
29	Create a 30-day optimisation cycle
30	Your discoverability audit worksheet

01 / FIELD GUIDE

Understand the discovery journey

A reader may arrive through search, category browsing, recommendations, an external link or an author page. Each route creates a different first impression. Map the route you want to strengthen before changing metadata.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **understand the discovery journey**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

- Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?
- What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?
- What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

02 / FIELD GUIDE

Begin with accurate book data

Confirm title, subtitle, author name, edition, language, publication date, series information and formats. Consistency across files and retailer pages reduces confusion and supports a professional presentation.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **begin with accurate book data**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

03 / FIELD GUIDE

Write for reader intent

Search phrases should reflect how a likely reader describes the book or problem. Start with the manuscript and audience; do not begin with a list of fashionable keywords unrelated to the content.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **write for reader intent**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

04 / FIELD GUIDE

Build a keyword research map

Group phrases by genre, subject, theme, setting, audience, format and distinctive topic. Note where each phrase came from and whether it accurately represents the book. Keep a record of rejected phrases and why.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **build a keyword research map**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

05 / FIELD GUIDE

Use comparable titles responsibly

Comparable titles help reveal category language and reader expectations. Select books with genuine similarities in genre, tone, audience or subject—not merely titles that are popular.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **use comparable titles responsibly**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

06 / FIELD GUIDE

Understand category fit

Categories are useful only when they truthfully describe the book. Review the marketplace’s current category options and eligibility rules. A category is not a shortcut to a ranking; relevance and reader satisfaction matter.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **understand category fit**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

07 / FIELD GUIDE

Review the book description

A description should help a reader decide whether the book is for them. Establish the hook, genre, stakes or core benefit, then give enough context to support a confident decision.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **review the book description**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

08 / FIELD GUIDE

Make the opening lines count

The first visible lines may carry much of the persuasion burden. Put the most distinctive, reader-relevant information early. Avoid starting with a long biography or generic praise.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **make the opening lines count**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

09 / FIELD GUIDE

Check cover-to-listing consistency

The cover, title, subtitle, description and category should tell a coherent story. Conflicting signals can attract the wrong audience and lead to disappointment.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **check cover-to-listing consistency**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

- Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?
- What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?
- What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

10 / FIELD GUIDE

Evaluate the sample experience

Where a sample or preview is available, check that it begins cleanly, displays well and represents the reading experience. Review front matter, formatting and the opening pages for avoidable friction.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **evaluate the sample experience**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

11 / FIELD GUIDE

Understand format relationships

Paperback, ebook, hardcover and audio editions may have different metadata or availability. Check that editions are correctly linked where supported and that format details are accurate.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **understand format relationships**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

12 / FIELD GUIDE

Review pricing context

Compare price, length, format and positioning with relevant titles. Pricing is a business decision, not a guaranteed ranking lever. Consider royalties, production costs, promotions and reader expectations.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **review pricing context**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

13 / FIELD GUIDE

Create an author-page pathway

A coherent author profile can help readers move from one title to another. Keep the biography, photo, series information and book catalogue accurate and current.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **create an author-page pathway**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

14 / FIELD GUIDE

Use series information strategically

For series fiction, clearly show order and continuity. For connected nonfiction, clarify which book is introductory and which is specialised. Avoid confusing series numbering or inconsistent naming.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **use series information strategically**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

15 / FIELD GUIDE

Consider A+ content carefully

Enhanced content can provide additional context through approved modules, visuals and structured messaging where available. It should answer reader questions, not repeat the description or make unsupported claims.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **consider a+ content carefully**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

- Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?
- What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?
- What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

16 / FIELD GUIDE

Design visual modules for scanning

Use a clear hierarchy: one message per module, readable text, purposeful images and consistent typography. Test on mobile and ensure that the meaning survives when images are viewed at smaller sizes.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **design visual modules for scanning**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

17 / FIELD GUIDE

Audit the listing as a whole

Review every visible element together: cover, title, description, editorial content, format options, series data, author information and enhanced content. Look for contradictions, missing details and weak calls to action.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **audit the listing as a whole**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

18 / FIELD GUIDE

Understand also-bought and recommendations

Recommendation carousels are platform-controlled and can change. Observe patterns as context, not proof of a guaranteed placement. Do not attempt artificial activity designed to manipulate recommendation systems.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **understand also-bought and recommendations**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

- Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?
- What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?
- What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

19 / FIELD GUIDE

Connect external traffic responsibly

When sharing a retailer link, make sure the destination matches the promoted format and territory. Use trackable links only when they respect privacy and platform rules. Never imply that external clicks guarantee ranking.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **connect external traffic responsibly**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

- Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?
- What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?
- What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

20 / FIELD GUIDE

Build a before-and-after record

Save screenshots or notes before edits. Record the exact changes, date, reason and expected effect. This makes later review more meaningful and avoids attributing unrelated changes to one edit.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **build a before-and-after record**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

21 / FIELD GUIDE

Understand keyword field limits

KDP fields and rules may change. Check current official instructions for the number of fields, character limits, prohibited terms and formatting. Avoid repeating title or author details where policy says not to.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **understand keyword field limits**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

22 / FIELD GUIDE

Avoid prohibited or misleading terms

Do not use competitor names, unrelated popular authors, misleading claims, temporary promotions or terms that do not describe the book. Compliance protects the listing and the reader relationship.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **avoid prohibited or misleading terms**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

23 / FIELD GUIDE

Plan controlled updates

Change a small number of related elements at a time when practical. Keep a dated record and allow enough time for the platform to process changes before drawing conclusions.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **plan controlled updates**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

24 / FIELD GUIDE

Measure what is available

Use the reporting tools available to your account and territory. Distinguish impressions, clicks, orders, royalties and page reads. Each metric answers a different question and may have different reporting delays.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **measure what is available**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

25 / FIELD GUIDE

Interpret results cautiously

A change in sales or ranking may reflect seasonality, advertising, price, reviews, competition or external events. Avoid declaring causation from a short time window or one metric.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **interpret results cautiously**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

26 / FIELD GUIDE

Troubleshoot weak conversion

If visitors arrive but do not buy, inspect the reader promise, cover, description, price, sample and review context. If few visitors arrive, revisit audience fit, external reach and metadata relevance.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **troubleshoot weak conversion**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

27 / FIELD GUIDE

Plan a listing refresh

Prioritise the biggest clarity issue first. A refresh may involve description, categories, keywords, series details or visual content. Keep changes accurate and aligned with the book.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **plan a listing refresh**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

- Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?
- What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?
- What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

28 / FIELD GUIDE

Keep a platform change log

Record official policy updates, interface changes and the date you checked them. Do not rely on old tutorials for current KDP procedures.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **keep a platform change log**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

29 / FIELD GUIDE

Create a 30-day optimisation cycle

Set a baseline, implement a focused improvement, observe available data and document what happened. Use the cycle to learn, not to chase daily ranking fluctuations.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **create a 30-day optimisation cycle**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

30 / FIELD GUIDE

Your discoverability audit worksheet

Complete a final review of relevance, clarity, compliance, visual presentation, reader journey and measurement. Identify the three highest-priority improvements.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **your discoverability audit worksheet**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

- Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?
- What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?
- What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes